

Operating costs — today and at scale

Cash costs, per-client cost of delivery, and labor (founder + hires) at each growth stage. Chat €299 / Compleet €499 pricing.

~€30
CASH BURN / MONTH
TODAY

~€10
COST PER CHAT CLIENT /
MONTH

~97%
GROSS MARGIN ON CHAT
TIER

~108 h
FOUNDER HOURS /
MONTH TODAY

1 CURRENT MONTHLY COSTS (JULY 2026)

ITEM	DETAIL	€ / MONTH
Hetzner cx23 server	runs receptionist demo + growth-engine x2, capacity ~30 clients	6.64
Google Workspace	davy@klantkraan.nl business email	~7
Anthropic API	demo chats, content drafts, nightly analyst — usage-based	5–15
Domain klantkraan.nl	annual, amortised	~1
Twilio WhatsApp	sandbox — near-zero until production number	~0
Cloudflare Pages, Telegram, X / Meta / TikTok APIs	free tiers	0
Total cash		~€20–30

2 CURRENT LABOR (FOUNDER)

WHO	DETAIL	HOURS / MO	VALUE / MO
Founder — build, content, sales	~25 h/wk front-loaded build phase; drops to 12–15 h/wk from first clients	~108	€5,400
Total incl. labor		cash + imputed founder time	~€5,430

Founder time valued at €50/h (opportunity-cost midpoint; market alternative ≈ €85/h contract rate). Unpaid today — sweat equity, not cash out. The plan starts a €3,500/mo founder draw around month 6 (~€4,700 MRR).

3 COST PER CLIENT SERVED (COGS)

CHAT — €299/MO		€ / MO	VOICE (COMPLEET) — €499/MO VIA SYNTHFLOW	
Claude API (~300 conversations)		3.00	All-in per minute (STT+TTS+LLM+telephony)	~€0.14
WhatsApp Business API fees		3.00	COGS at 750 included minutes	~€106
Server share + Mollie SEPA		0.75	Margin at €499 / 750 min / €0.40 overage	71–79%
Monitoring + buffer		3.25		
COGS → margin 96.7%		€10		
Never flat-rate voice: a busy season month (2,500 min) drops a flat €499 to 30% margin. The overage structure holds ≥70% at every volume.				

Also per client: ~2 h founder setup time (covered by the €249 one-time setup fee) and a dedicated WhatsApp number (~€1.50/mo). Add roughly €10/mo per chat client and ~€106/mo per voice client on top of the fixed base below.

4 MONTHLY COSTS AT SCALE — BY STAGE (INCL. LABOR)

STAGE	CLIENTS	MRR	INFRA + TOOLS	COGS	HIRES	CASH TOTAL	FOUNDER H/WK	INCL. FOUNDER*
Today — pre-revenue	0	€0	€30	€0	—	€30	~25	€5,400
First clients	10	€3.0k	€200	€100	—	€300	12–15	€3,200
Post-VA	22	€5.8k	€300	€220	€600 VA	€1,100	12	€3,700
Post-SDR + ads	~50	€15k	€950	€500	€2,700 VA+SDR	€4,200	12	€6,800
Post-engineer	60–85	€25k	€960	€700	€6,000 VA+SDR+eng	€7,700	12	€10,300

*Founder time at €50/h; replaced by the €3,500/mo draw once it starts (~month 6). SDR figure includes ~10% commission on sourced deals. COGS assumes chat-only mix; each voice client adds ~€96 over a chat client and ~€200 revenue. Infra grows one €6.64 server per ~30 clients.

5 WHAT SCALING ADDS — TRIGGER LADDER

Going live first paying clients	Twilio WhatsApp production number (NL regulatory bundle or BYO prepaid SIM); Mollie billing (per-transaction only)	~€20/mo
~10 clients compliance checkpoint	One-pass privacy-lawyer review; business insurance stack; EU AI Act legal review (one-off €2–3k against year 1); build the deferred /admin panel + ROI reports	+€150/mo + one-offs
12 active clients ~month 5–6	Hire #1 — VA , 30 h/mo: onboarding ops, QA, monitoring. Averts the founder-time wall at ~22 clients	€600/mo
€15k MRR ~month 11	Hire #2 — freelance SDR + 10% commission; optionally switch on Google Ads (€400) and the outbound tool stack (€146)	€1.5–2k/mo
€25k MRR or voice backlog	Hire #3 — part-time engineer (1–2 d/wk): voice hardening, ERP/calendar integrations	€2.5–4k/mo
~10 voice clients	Revisit Synthflow white-label (~\$2k/mo, breaks even ~6 clients) or Enterprise tier — lowers per-minute COGS above ~10k min/mo	optional
BV conversion	NL accountant at incorporation; Moneybird (€12/mo) suffices until then	€1.5–2.5k/yr

6 BREAKEVEN CHECKPOINTS

COVERS	MRR NEEDED	≈ CLIENTS
Today's real cash burn (~€30/mo)	€30	1
Fully-loaded modeled overhead incl. ads (~€950/mo)	~€1,000	4
Overhead + €3,500/mo founder draw	~€4,700	16

The constraint is not cost. At ~97% gross margin and <1-month CAC payback, economics scale almost for free — roughly €10 per added chat client. What scaling actually costs is **labor**: the VA → SDR → engineer ladder exists to keep founder time at ~12 h/wk while the client book grows from 10 to 60+.

Sources: 07-finance/cogs-per-tier.md, unit-economics.md, first-hire-triggers.md, mrr-projections.md (herzien 2026-07-13); research/synthflow-margin-model.md (2026-07-21); live infra state per ops server. COGS figures are conservative estimates pending real usage data — reconcile against actual per-client Claude/WhatsApp spend after the first paying clients.